DESIGN SYSTEMS

TECHNICAL DATA SHEET STARMIX
WHITE PRE-MIXED CEMENT-BASED MORTAR

DESCRIPTION

The STAMPED PLASTER (Intonaco Stampato) “Wall System” uses 4 products:

- Starmix, white pre-mixed plaster.
- Retop, a release agent that prevents the stamping mats from sticking to the Starmix mortar
- Protewall, which protects the surface from weathering.
- ColorStyle, a colouring product which, with its 7 different shades, gives an antiqued effect and greater resistance to the finished product.

Starmix plaster is a ready-to-use pre-mixed compound, created specifically for producing stamped and textured plasters. Depending on the temperature, the Starmix mix allows a working time of approximately 5 hours. Again depending on the temperature, the Starmix product makes it possible to re-model the work previously carried out, even on the following day, because the product will still be soft, or at least friable, the next day.

GENERAL INFORMATION

Thanks to its characteristics, Starmix achieves excellent bonding on almost all common substrates (tuff, concrete, plasterboard, various types of brickwork, plasters, external thermal insulation systems, etc.); it has a medium elasticity sufficient to withstand any slight settlement of the substrate, and stamping will be optimal for every type of pattern. It is also sufficiently thixotropic to allow a thickness of 1 to 5 cm in a single application. It can be finished: smooth, relief, orange-peel, roller, stamped, etc. It has excellent resistance to UV rays and abrasion.

Advantages

Thanks to its composition, Starmix is both water-repellent and breathable. It is also resistant to the weather, industrial fumes (acid and alkaline), alkaline solutions, infrared and ultraviolet rays, water and atmospheric agents in general; for all these characteristics it is suitable for both indoor and outdoor environments.

APPLICATION METHOD

SUBSTRATES

Surface preparation

The substrate must not be dusting; it must be sound, clean, dry and free from dust or grease; friable or detached parts, laitance or other foreign substances must be carefully removed. Starmix can be applied over many substrates, but its application over water-repellent substrates (e.g. plastic coatings), paints, gypsum, etc. is not recommended.

- When applying on reinforced concrete walls, it is advisable to wash thoroughly with hydrochloric acid and a pressure washer, followed by application of our Polimero 20 primer, diluted 1/1 with water with the

addition of cement; this mix must be spread on the wall. It is recommended to apply it a little at a time and to apply the Starmix product wet-on-wet. Alternatively, mix one part of Polimero 20 with 2 parts of water, add the Starmix product until a homogeneous paste-like mix is obtained, skim the wall with a notched trowel in cross-wise strokes and apply the Starmix product the following day.

- Application on plasterboard is recommended with attention to the load-bearing structure of the plasterboard itself, which will also have to support the weight of the Stamped Plaster. Apply the Poliresin L2 primer in a proportion of 1 part product to 3 parts water; it must be left to dry completely, at least 3 hours, before laying the Starmix.
- On substrates such as various types of brickwork or sand-and-cement plasters, the substrate must be wetted to saturation, preferably the evening before; at the time of application the substrate must be damp. Very dry substrates must be well hydrated, as above, to avoid any crazing and/or cracks.
- In the case of substrates made of tuff, friable plasters or plasters with a tensile strength lower than that of our product (such as commonly used pre-mixed products), the surface must be reinforced with our Poliresin L2 product, applied to saturation on the surface in a proportion of one part Poliresin L2 to 3 parts water; the Starmix pre-mixed product can be laid approximately 3 hours after the last application

All surfaces must be flat and free from micro-cracks; otherwise micro-cracks and/or cracks may occur in our applied and stamped product. At low temperatures and in the presence of moisture, the product may show efflorescence due to salts and/or damp stains. On new structures, Starmix will follow any settlement of the wall. Structural joints must be made in the coating. Substrates of a different nature that are weak must be strengthened by applying Poliresin L2 uniformly as in point (2).

On walls with particular rising damp and showing possible salt efflorescence, suitable preparation is recommended before producing our Stamped Plaster.

Mixing Starmix

Mix the Starmix product with approximately 5,5 l of water using a hand mixer or a plastering machine (carry out a preliminary test to find the right air chamber setting for spraying our Starmix product); in each 25 kg bag of Starmix (165 g corresponds to a full plastic cup of Pemid product), take care to obtain a homogeneous mix, mixing for a few minutes.

Let the product rest for approximately 5 minutes and apply it within one hour. The mix must not be used at temperatures below 5° or above 35°. At temperatures of around 20°, the Starmix product allows a working time of approximately 5 hours at a thickness of 2,5 cm; at warmer temperatures (not above 35° is recommended) it must be applied in several stages, coloured wet-on-wet and stamped immediately.

The ColorStyle product can also be added to the Starmix product; in this way the whole Starmix mix is coloured, obtaining various colourings of the product. The proportion of ColorStyle colourant mixed with the Starmix pre-mixed product, expressed as a percentage, may vary; a sufficient percentage is approximately 2 kg (8%) of ColorStyle colourant per 25 kg bag of Starmix.

Applying Starmix

Starmix is applied like ordinary pre-mixed plasters. A minimum thickness of 1 cm can be applied, although it is preferable to apply at least 1,5 cm of product. Fix wooden battens to the wall to act as guides, with the

thickness given in the table according to the type of stamping mat chosen. Once the Starmix product has been applied at the set thickness, wet and trowel the surface with a steel finishing trowel before colouring, completely softening the surface layer. Then colour with the ColorStyle product.

Colouring

By applying the ColorStyle product, the wall is coloured before it is even stamped. Choose the shade from the colour chart or create it by mixing several colours together. For greater protection of the STAMPED PLASTER product, spread ColorStyle wet-on-wet over the whole surface, so as to protect and strengthen it further. Depending on the temperature, it is recommended to wet and trowel the surface with a steel finishing trowel before stamping, completely softening the surface layer. The ColorStyle product can be applied by brush, spray, roller, etc. and then trowelled and stamped

Stamping

Stamping is carried out using rubber stamping mats previously wetted with the Retop product, which prevents the ColorStyle from sticking to the mat. Wet and trowel the surface with a steel finishing trowel before stamping, completely softening the surface layer; it is important that no surface cracks appear, although these can be repaired immediately after stamping or even on the following day. Once the whole surface has been stamped with the chosen pattern(s), the product is left to dry and, depending on the temperature, it is finished on the same day or the following day using Design Systems engraving tools. Since stamping lowers the level of the Starmix mortar, it may create micro-cracks, as may wind and/or high temperatures.

These micro-cracks do not create structural problems for the product; they can be repaired by closing them with the Starmix product or with ColorStyle.

Protection of the substrate

Once finished, the Stamped Plaster must be protected with the Protewall product by spray, brush or roller, taking care to avoid runs

Average output

3 operators with a plastering machine can apply and stamp approximately 100 m^2 of Stamped Plaster per day; by hand, the same operators can produce approximately 40/50 m^2. In summer the same areas can be achieved, provided the product is applied a little at a time and stamping is then carried out before the surface crust forms (see previous point, ColorStyle).

COVERAGE

25 kg of product covers approximately 1,70 m^2 at a thickness of 1 cm.

PACKAGING

25 kg of product covers approximately 1,70 m^2 at a thickness of 1 cm. Moisture-proof 25 kg bag.

DESIGN SYSTEMS

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